

Persistence Techniques

CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

Domains:

- 4.0 Attacks and Exploits
- 5.0 Post-exploitation and Lateral Movement

Objectives:

- 4.10: Given a scenario, use scripting to automate attacks.
- 5.1: Given a scenario, perform tasks to establish and maintain persistence.
- 5.2: Given a scenario, perform tasks to move laterally throughout the environment.

Video Overview

In this video on persistence techniques, you'll gain a foundational understanding of how maintaining access to compromised systems is achieved in the realm of penetration testing. This material directly aligns with key exam objectives, focusing on how scripting automates attacks, how to establish and maintain persistence, and how to move laterally within an environment. As you watch, consider how these techniques, though presented in a cybersecurity context, mirror real-world scenarios where continuous access or influence is sought, whether in business, politics, or even personal relationships. Understanding these methods is not just about passing an exam; it's about developing a comprehensive perspective on how digital security landscapes are navigated and secured, skills that are highly relevant to your future careers in IT and beyond.

Key Topics Covered

- Defining persistence in penetration testing
- Trojans as a persistence technique using Metasploit
- Implementing backdoors, including user accounts and software-based methods
- Reverse shells vs. bind shells for establishing connections
- Using daemons and services for background persistence in Linux/Unix and Windows
- Scheduled tasks for persistence using Cron jobs in Linux and Task Scheduler in Windows
- PowerShell Empire and its persistence modules

Student Notes Section